



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Prudentia Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.prudentiaacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Prudentia Classical Academy (Lake Charles, LA, 70605) presents a clearly classical Christian program, with strong alignment to the six essential elements of classical education. Public-facing materials emphasize classical Christian formation, truth-seeking, virtue, and wisdom, often framed within a theology-driven, God-honoring worldview. The curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), humanities, memory work, and recitation, with explicit upper-school Socratic-style dialogue and a culminating rhetoric emphasis. There is consistent emphasis on parent partnership and a public-facing mission to partner with families in educating children to think and act biblically, seek truth and virtue, and pursue wisdom. Taken together, the school's public materials indicate a CLASSICAL orientation across most categories, with particularly strong evidence in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Parents & Community. Some elements related to Faculty portrayal are less explicit, contributing to a plausible but somewhat weaker signal there, which places Element 5 as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Overall, the school earns an aggregate CLASSICAL rating.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The school describes itself as a classical Christian education organization, explicitly tying formation to a Christian framework and stating commitments to think and act biblically, seek truth and virtue, and pursue wisdom (mission statements in multiple PCA materials).
- A formal Statement on Marriage, Gender, and Sexuality anchors theological commitments and Christian distinctives in school governance (biblical criteria and Christian doctrinal stance).
- Public-facing materials repeatedly present a God-centered worldview, references to God's grace, and Christian identity in the school's mission and history (e.g., "glorify God and serve our community by providing an academically robust Christian, classical education").
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present positive keywords aligned with category signals: truth, virtue, wisdom, God, biblically/theology, Christian education, sacred/Christian framing (e.g., "truth and virtue," "pursue wisdom," "biblically," "God," "Statement of Faith").
- Negative signals are not evident in the public materials for this category (no explicit relativism or secular ethics signals detected here).
- Why this rating
- The materials foreground transcendental moral realism, objective theological commitments, and liturgical/community cues consistent with a theologically grounded classical school, signaling CLASSICAL in this domain. The explicit theology and Christian formation are central to PCA's identity, aligning

with the Positive Keywords in the classical lexicon's Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and its associated indicators (truth, virtue, theology, liturgy/worship, wonder).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The mission statement emphasizes formation through “classically educating children to think and act biblically, seek truth and virtue, and pursue wisdom” and the aim to glorify God via a classical Christian framework, indicating virtue- and wisdom-centered aims rather than mere job-readiness.
- The framing of education as formation in a liberal-arts, classical mold aligns with the pursuit of the true, the good, and the beautiful as real and knowable through human inquiry, consistent with the classical aim (telos; pursuit of virtue and wisdom) in the lexicon's School Purpose/Goal signals.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive signals: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, pursuit of truth/beauty, classical mission, contemplation (as framed in the lexicon's School Purpose/Goal keywords) appear in PCA materials and mission statements; e.g., formation/virtue/wisdom appear directly in PCA messages, the lexicon's signals align with formation and virtue concepts (formation, virtue, wisdom).
- Negative signals: none of the workforce- or job-prep oriented negative indicators appear in PCA materials for this category; the available content emphasizes formation over immediate job-specific outcomes.
- Why this rating
- PCA's stated aims center on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful in a classical framework, consistent with CLASSICAL signals in the lexicon and with the school's own mission statements. The absence of a vocational readiness emphasis in public materials supports CLASSICAL rather than a partially modern, job-focused orientation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Curriculum is explicitly built around classic liberal-arts scaffolding: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric (Art of Letters; Humanities; memory work/recitation); Logic School; Rhetoric School; Senior Thesis trajectory; and a heavy emphasis on classical/humanities content (history, literature, geography) with traditional computational subjects (Saxon Math) and memory-based pedagogy in the lower levels.
- The program explicitly uses the Art of Letters, Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric as foundational elements, with the Humanities and a memory-focused approach woven through the program, plus the presence of a Logic years sequence and a Rhetoric School culminating in a Senior Thesis (indicative of classical pedagogy).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts framing (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books/Great Conversation signals are implied by the classical canon approach (e.g., memory work, recitation, primary texts in humanities); the Trivium framework is evident via explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric sequencing and the presence of a rhetoric/senior-thesis trajectory.
- Negative keywords: not prominently present in PCA's public materials; no clear shift toward project-based dominance or STEM-first framing in the core public curriculum descriptions (rather, a traditional liberal-arts emphasis).
- Why this rating
- The curriculum repeatedly centers on the Trivium and Quadrivium-inspired structure (grammar/logic/rhetoric) with memory work and a classical humanities emphasis, together with a Rhetoric School and Senior Thesis, which strongly align with CLASSICAL expectations per the Six Essential Elements lexicon and associated indicators.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Pedagogical approach explicitly includes contemplative/restful dimensions (scholé-like restfulness and contemplation), memory-based learning (recitation and memory work), chanting/singing in lower levels, and Socratic/seminar-style activities in upper levels (Socratic discussion, seminars, debates; rhetoric training; senior thesis oral defense) ,.
- The lower school emphasis on singing/chanting to deepen memory and delight aligns with classical pedagogy signals from the lexicon (narration/recitation, chanting, memory work) and the “scholé” concept in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminars, narration/recitation, chanting, memory work, restfulness/scholé, rhetoric exercises, debates, Senior Thesis. These elements show strong alignment with classical pedagogy signals in the lexicon (Socratic dialogue, recitation, chanting; scholé; seminars; rhetoric; debate) , turn0file3□, turn0file0□.
- Negative keywords: minimal presence of purely project-based, constructivist, or experiential-only approaches in core public materials; the dominant signals emphasize classical practices over non-traditional models.
- Why this rating
- The school’s described methods strongly reflect classical teaching methods (contemplative/restful pedagogy, memory-based learning, Socratic seminars, and rhetoric-focused performance), which aligns squarely with the CLASSICAL category in the rubric and lexicon ,.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize leadership by a Head of School and co-founders, governance by a board, and a network of teachers; however, explicit statements that the faculty themselves are “the living curriculum,” or a formal “portrait of a teacher” in the public materials are less evident. Founders, head of school, and board are clearly identified; explicit living-curriculum or faculty-pedagogical profiles are not prominently stated in accessible public pages (as opposed to the classic per-category faculty signals found in the knowledge base). These signals suggest a classical orientation is present but less explicitly articulated in the public-facing materials for this category ,.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present positive signals: explicit leadership roles (Head of School, co-founders, board members), governance and mission alignment with classical aims; these map reasonably to the Faculty signals (model teachers/mentors, living curriculum) in the classical lexicon, but explicit textual claims about the faculty as “the living curriculum” are not directly shown in the public content (which yields a partial signal) ,.
- Negative signals: absence of explicit, explicit statements about faculty as the “living curriculum” or detailed faculty profiles in the public materials; this reduces the strength of a full CLASSICAL signal for this category.
- Why this rating
- The category shows many CLASSICAL signals (leadership by founders and a governance structure; alignment with classical aims in mission), but the lack of explicit “living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, or detailed faculty profiles” in public-facing content reduces the strength to a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal for Element 5. The complexity and formalization of the faculty identity are implicit rather than explicit in the available content, yielding a cautious classification.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes robust parent partnerships and family involvement: “Parent Partnership,” parents as co-teachers, and a strong emphasis on parent formation (reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs) are present; the site highlights multiple opportunities for families to participate (open campus events, book clubs, information meetings, open houses) and to learn about classical education via gatherings and resources ,.

- The Six Essential Elements lexicon signals for Parents & Community emphasize partnership with families, parent formation, and open-campus access as core signals of a classical community orientation; PCA's materials strongly reflect these signals (parent partnership; openness to visits; community engagement events).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present positive keywords: partnership with families, parents as co-teachers, open campus, parent formation, family involvement, classical parent training, book clubs, gatherings, parent education content on the website, and community events (Open Houses, Information Meetings) ,.
- Negative signals: none evident in public materials; PCA presents a clear co-educator model with the public-facing materials highlighting parental engagement and education.
- Why this rating
- PCA's explicit emphasis on partnering with families, parental formation, and open access to school activities aligns strongly with the CLASSICAL signal for Parents & Community in the lexicon, yielding a CLASSICAL rating for Element 6.

Aggregate ranking - Category ratings: - 1) CLASSICAL - 2) CLASSICAL - 3) CLASSICAL - 4) CLASSICAL - 5) SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - 6) CLASSICAL - Overall: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - For a school already classified CLASSICAL, moving toward an even stronger CLASSICAL signal could involve: - Explicitly publishing a formal "Living Curriculum" statement about faculty as the living curriculum, including portraits of faculty standards and profiles that connect teacher formation to student formation (to strengthen Element 5). - Expanding explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and citation on the public site to underscore the full liberal-arts canon in Element 3. - Publishing more direct evidence of liturgical/communal practices (e.g., explicit liturgy, chapel, or regular liturgical rhythms) to strengthen Element 1 signals related to liturgical practices, if desired by governance.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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